

Generated from the competition table

1956 Men's Ballon d'Or

Everything the Men's Ballon d'Or table records about 1956, with the winner linked to their full award history and their national team linked to its own record.

Winner

Stanley Matthews

National team

England

Ceremony date

18 December 1956

The story of this edition

Stanley Matthews won the first-ever Ballon d'Or in 1956.

All Men's Ballon d'Or editions →



References & review

Status: verified

Last reviewed: 1 September 2026

- Official winners and rankings (<https://ballondor.com/all-rankings>)
- Official homepage (<https://ballondor.com/>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.rsssf.org/miscellaneous/europa-poy65.html>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.britannica.com/topic/Ballon-dOr>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.jeuneafrique.com/381505/politique/jour-26-dece-mbre-1995-george-weah-elu-ballon-dor/>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.voanews.com/>).

- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.uefa.com/uefachampionsleague/news/>).
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (<https://www.si.com/soccer/what-is-the-kopa-trophy-past-winners-nominees-2025>).
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (<https://www.90min.com/what-is-kopa-trophy-past-winners-nominees>).
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (<https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/kopa-trophy.htm>).
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (<https://www.sportsdunia.com/football-analysis/list-of-kopa-trophy-winners>).
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (<https://www.chaseyoursport.com/football/list-of-kopa-trophy-winners/8061>).
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (<https://www.givemesport.com/every-winner-kopa-trophy-ranked/>).
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kopa_Trophy).
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (<https://www.fcbarcelona.com/en/football/first-team/news/4367534/lamine-yamal-retains-kopa-trophy/featured>).
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (https://www.tntsports.co.uk/football/ballon-d-or/2025/lamine-yamal-retains-kopa-trophy-for-best-young-player-vicky-lopez-takes-inaugural-womens-prize_sto23224406/story.shtml).
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (<https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/yashin-trophy.htm>).
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (<https://www.premierleague.com/en/news/4420829/donnarumma-and-gyokeres-win-awards-at-2025-ballon-dor>).
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (<https://goaltheball.com/yashin-trophy-winners-list/>).
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (<https://www.fotmob.com/el/news/x3syvn394xhu179pkuk2k9k4y/ballon-d-or-2019-liverpool-goalskeeper-alisson-wins-inaugural-yachine-trophy>).
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (<https://www.goal.com/en-ca/lists/aston-villa-and-argentina-goalskeeper-emiliano-martinez-retains-yashin-trophy-as-world-s-best-goalskeeper-in-2024/blt47f77564722f26b5>).

- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (https://fr.wikipedia.org/wiki/Troph%C3%A9e_Yachine).
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (<https://www.footmercato.net/a7278391082899020163-ballon-dor-2025-gianluigi-donnarumma-remporte-le-trophee-yachine>).
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (<https://www.realmadrid.com/en-US/news/football/first-team/special-features/courtois-yashin-trophy-winner-2022>).
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (<https://www.tntsports.co.uk/football/ballon-d-or/2022/ballon-dor-2022-thibaut-courtois-wins-yashin-trophy-for-best-goalkeeper-after-real-madrid-heroics-la-sto9191911/story.shtml>).
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (<https://www.90min.com/posts/emiliano-martinez-wins-2023-yashin-trophy>).
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (<https://www.besoccer.com/new/emiliano-martinez-wins-back-to-back-yachine-trophy-awards-1335839>).

Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.